

Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion — Research

Research

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Release: 2026.07

Indigenous percussion, Kaamulan, marching heritage

0.1 Manual volumes in this release

PDF	Description
00-Trainers-Manual.pdf	Field teaching handbook for instructors and pilot collaborators
01-Specifications.pdf	Identity framework, blueprint, design principles, notation standards
02-Reference.pdf	Concept library, technique, grids, sound model
03-User-Guides.pdf	Instructor, pilot, arranging, and educational guidance
04-Research.pdf	Indigenous percussion, Kaamulan, marching heritage

PDF	Description
05-Architecture.pdf	Documentation architecture and ADRs
06-Governance.pdf	EDF governance, metadata, change management
07-AI-Development.pdf	AI-assisted workflow and project development notes
08-Templates-and-Placeholders.pdf	Templates and inactive EDF domain placeholders

1 Research

Research notes and analysis supporting Philippine rhythmic authenticity, marching-percussion practice, pedagogy, instrumentation, and visual design belong here.

Research documents use structured profiles (definition, context, translation questions, sources, status). Stable findings migrate to the [Concept Library](#) when field-confirmed.

1.1 Contents

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion](#) — concept and performance-practice research profiles
- [Kaamulan Festival](#) — Bukidnon festival research topics and field profiles
- [Philippine Marching Heritage](#) — military, Drum & Lyre, and modern marching lineage

1.2 Related Documents

- [Research Backlog](#)
- [Concept Library](#)
- [References](#)
- [Project Journal](#)

2 Indigenous Philippine Percussion

Status: Draft **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Cultural research and concept development **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-15 **Review Frequency:** Annual **Authoritative:** No

2.1 Purpose

This document records research on indigenous Philippine percussion traditions as the deepest cultural roots of the project. Findings inform the [Identity Framework](#) and [Concept Library](#).

The project respectfully adapts indigenous ideas rather than attempting literal recreation. See [Translate Musical Ideas—Not Instruments \(Trainers Manual\)](#).

This is a **research synthesis** document. Stable definitions migrate to the [Concept Library](#). Practical teaching migrates to the [Educational Handbook](#). Raw field notes belong in the [Project Journal](#).

2.2 How to Read This Document

Each concept and performance practice uses a consistent research template:

Field	Purpose
What it is	Plain-language definition
Where it appears	Region, tradition, or context
Why it matters to this project	Link to Philippine identity in fusion work
Translation question	How to adapt on modern battery without imitation
Project links	Related specs, references, and technique docs
Sources and contributors	Recordings, citations, instructor input
Status	Outline, field-confirmed, disputed, or migrated

Status key: **Outline** = framework only, pending validation · **Field-confirmed** = supported by instructor or source review · **Migrated** = stable content moved to Concept Library

2.3 Cross-Tradition Awareness

Many performance concepts (open tone, interlocking, call-and-response, body movement) also appear in other hand-drum traditions worldwide. Comparative awareness is useful for pedagogy, but the **cultural foundation of this project remains Philippine**. Do not present parallel traditions as interchangeable sources of identity.

2.4 Important Concepts

2.4.1 Layered Rhythmic Structures

What it is

Multiple rhythmic layers combine—foundation pulse, answering figures, ornamental accents—to create a single composite groove larger than any one part.

Where it appears

Indigenous and community percussion across the Philippines; festival ensembles; hand-drum groups where each player carries a partial pattern. Pending detailed Bukidnon/Kaamulan field mapping with MONHS pilot instructors.

Why it matters to this project

Layered structure is the musical logic behind the **Core Blueprint** three-layer method (soul, precision, contrast) and bass-split grids in **Grid Exercises**.

Translation question

How do snare, tenor, and bass lines interlock so the battery sounds like one festival ensemble rather than three foreign rudimental voices?

Project links

- **Grid Exercises — Bass Drum Linear Fiesta Split (Trainers Manual)**
- **Interlocking Rhythms (Trainers Manual)**
- **Philippine Festival Rhythms (Trainers Manual)**

Sources and contributors

- Pending: MONHS instructor interviews
- Pending: curated recordings in [References](#)

Status: Outline

2.4.2 Call-and-Response

What it is

A musical dialogue in which one voice or group presents a phrase and another answers—between players, sub-groups, or performers and audience.

Where it appears

Community festival drumming, ceremonial pacing, ensemble communication in hand-drum traditions, and audience-facing performance throughout the Philippines. Bukidnon/Kaamulan contexts are a primary pilot reference—see [Kaamulan Festival](#).

Why it matters to this project

Call-and-response is central to audience connection, sectional listening, and the Identity Framework **Community** principle. It connects indigenous roots to Drum & Lyre rehearsal culture without copying foreign show templates.

Translation question

How do battery sections “answer” each other—and the audience—without mimicking indigenous instrument roles?

Practical starting guidance

Stable teaching steps, rehearsal checks, and pilot notes are in [Call and Response — Practical Implementation \(Trainers Manual\)](#) (Concept Library). Use that section for first rehearsals; use this research profile for cultural context and MONHS field validation.

Project links

- [Call and Response \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Community Performance Traditions \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Instructor Introduction](#) — collaboration framing for MONHS educators

Sources and contributors

- **Field work prompt for MONHS instructors:** Where do you already use call-and-response in Drum & Lyre teaching? What should never be transferred to written battery parts?

Status: Outline — priority for MONHS pilot confirmation

2.4.3 Community Participation

What it is

Music is not a detached concert event; community members participate as players, responders, movers, or active audience. Percussion anchors collective celebration.

Where it appears

Barrio fiestas, town festivals, street processions, school and civic parades, and indigenous ceremonial gatherings.

Why it matters to this project

Explains why visual energy, audience engagement, and movement integration are identity requirements—not optional showmanship borrowed from HBCU or DCI models.

Translation question

How does a school corps performance keep community-facing energy when repertoire becomes notated and technically complex?

Project links

- [Identity Framework — Community and Festival Traditions \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Movement and Dance \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Sources and contributors

- Pending: MONHS rehearsal and performance observations (Project Journal)

Status: Outline

2.4.4 Music Integrated with Movement

What it is

Rhythm, gesture, and dance are not separate domains. Footwork, torso motion, and stick or hand movement co-define the musical phrase.

Where it appears

Festival processions, indigenous ceremonial performance, and community dance-percussion traditions. Kaamulan research tracks movement-percussion relationships.

Why it matters to this project

Supports the Identity Framework principle that visual design must reinforce music rooted in Philippine tradition—not imitate foreign drill templates.

Translation question

Which movement ideas can translate into Drum & Lyre staging and stick visuals without appropriating sacred gesture?

Project links

- [Kaamulan Festival](#)
- [Core Blueprint — Visual Identity \(Specifications\)](#)
- [Movement and Dance \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Sources and contributors

- Pending: dance-percussion field notes (see Research Program below)

Status: Outline

2.4.5 Rhythmic Endurance

What it is

Sustained repetitive patterns at dance tempo over long periods—endurance of groove, attention, and collective time rather than short technical displays.

Where it appears

Festival street drumming, processional playing, and community celebrations requiring hours of continuous performance.

Why it matters to this project

Warm-up and grid pedagogy must build sustainable mechanics ([Legato Stroke, 8-8-16](#)) so technical advancement does not sacrifice the endurance character of Filipino festival playing.

Translation question

How do progressive exercises increase technical demand without shortening the rhythmic breath of festival groove?

Project links

- [Educational Handbook — Hybrid Warm-Up System \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Eight_Eight_Sixteen](#)

Sources and contributors

- Pending: comparison of traditional rehearsal duration vs. school corps schedules

Status: Outline

2.4.6 Ceremonial Performance

What it is

Performance governed by ritual order, symbolic pacing, and cultural meaning—not only entertainment tempo. Dynamics of entry, climax, and release follow ceremonial logic.

Where it appears

Indigenous gatherings, festival openings, processional arcs, and culturally significant public events.

Why it matters to this project

Informs show architecture and cadence design: when to build, when to release, and how to respect pacing that feels culturally grounded rather than arbitrarily “DCI-shaped.”

Translation question

How should a school show arc reflect ceremonial pacing without claiming sacred ritual content?

Project links

- [Kaamulan Festival](#)
- [Identity Framework — Historical Foundation \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Sources and contributors

- Pending: instructor guidance on appropriate vs. inappropriate ceremonial reference in school contexts

Status: Outline

2.4.7 Regional Diversity

What it is

The Philippines contains many distinct rhythmic languages, instrument roles, and performance customs—not a single generic “Filipino” sound.

Where it appears

Across Luzon, Visayas, Mindanao, and indigenous nations; festival traditions such as Sinulog, Dinagyang, and Kaamulan differ in accent placement and ensemble interaction.

Why it matters to this project

Prevents flattening indigenous and festival sources into one fusion cliché. [Grid Exercises](#) name specific regional inspirations (e.g. Sinulog-DCI hybrid) that must remain documented and respectful.

Translation question

Which regional traits are appropriate for this corps and this repertoire—and who authorizes that choice?

Project links

- [Regional Musical Traditions \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- Research Program — regional rhythmic studies

Sources and contributors

- **MONHS/Bukidnon instructors** — primary validators for Mindanao context
- Pending: Visayan festival reference material in [references/](#)

Status: Outline

2.4.8 Collective Groove

What it is

The felt “pocket” when all players lock into shared time, accent philosophy, and forward motion—greater than the sum of individual parts.

Where it appears

Indigenous interlocking ensembles, festival drum lines, and community processions where ensemble unity defines musical success.

Why it matters to this project

Collective groove is the sonic target of the [Philippine Percussion Sound Model](#). Technique refs ([Accent-Taps](#), [Grid Exercises](#)) exist to serve groove—not replace it.

Translation question

Does this battery passage still groove as one community instrument when played by students with mixed reading ability?

Project links

- [Interlocking Rhythms \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Philippine Percussion Sound Model](#)
- [Identity Preservation Checklist \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Sources and contributors

- Pending: pilot rehearsal recordings and instructor feedback (MONHS 2026)

Status: Outline — priority for MONHS pilot confirmation

2.5 Performance Practices to Study

Identity policy summary: [Indigenous Percussion Performance Practices \(Trainers Manual\)](#) (Identity Framework). This section expands each practice for research and battery translation.

Each practice below describes observable indigenous hand-drumming behavior, its musical function, and a **battery translation hypothesis**—not a finished notation rule.

2.5.1 Open Tone Concepts

Observed practice

A full, resonant stroke that allows the drumhead to speak openly—often the primary carrying tone in hand-drum ensemble texture.

Musical function

Projection, pulse clarity, and forward motion in collective groove.

Battery translation hypothesis

Maps to full **legato strokes** and high accent heights (9”–12”) on snare and tenor—not timbre imitation on modern heads.

Respect and limits

Do not label battery sounds as specific indigenous instrument names unless community advisors approve.

Field work needed

Confirm which open-tone characters MONHS instructors associate with festival vs. corps repertoire.

Status: Outline

2.5.2 Muted Articulations

Observed practice

Controlled dampened strokes—hand, finger, or stick technique that shortens resonance for texture or rhythmic definition.

Musical function

Inner-note clarity, contrast against open tones, and rhythmic speech in dense textures.

Battery translation hypothesis

Relates to low **tap strokes** (approximately 3”), rim clicks, and controlled dead-stroke figures in grid writing.

Respect and limits

Muted articulation on battery is a translation of **function** (short vs. open), not a claim of ethnic timbre.

Field work needed

Identify whether traditional DLC players already use analogous short vs. open contrast in rote repertoire.

Status: Outline

2.5.3 Accented Gestures

Observed practice

Deliberate physical emphasis—stick angle, hand shape, or attack velocity—that signals phrase leadership or ceremonial accent.

Musical function

Structural markers, call figures, and ensemble cues.

Battery translation hypothesis

Connects to accent grids, rim-shot figures (ˆ in [Grid Exercises](#)), and DCI height hierarchy—always subordinate to Philippine phrase shape.

Respect and limits

Avoid copying sacred gesture; adapt **accent role** only.

Field work needed

Instructor review of which accents read as “festival” vs. “foreign” to student audiences.

Status: Outline

2.5.4 Interlocking Rhythms

Observed practice

Players divide a continuous pattern so each performs a fragment; the composite line is heard as one rhythm.

Musical function

Density, collective intelligence, and distributed responsibility in ensemble time.

Battery translation hypothesis

Snare splits, tenor orchestration, and bass [linear fiesta grids](#) ([Trainers Manual](#)). See [Split Orchestration](#) ([Trainers Manual](#)).

Respect and limits

Interlocking is a universal technique; attribute Philippine **groove content**, not the mechanism itself.

Field work needed

MONHS instructors demonstrate existing interlocking habits in Drum & Lyre rote teaching.

Status: Outline — priority for pilot

2.5.5 Ensemble Communication

Observed practice

Players cue, answer, and adjust in real time through eye contact, auditory lead, and shared movement.

Musical function

Maintains collective groove under processional conditions and changing outdoor acoustics.

Battery translation hypothesis

Rehearsal methodology: section leaders, call-and-response checks, and visual tempo leadership in [Educational Handbook](#).

Respect and limits

Communication practices must be taught as ensemble musicianship, not as costume or stereotype.

Field work needed

Document how MONHS corps currently coordinates entries and releases.

Status: Outline

2.5.6 Body Movement**Observed practice**

Torso, arm, and foot movement co-articulate rhythm—especially in festival and dance-percussion contexts.

Musical function

Energy transmission, visual unity, and audience connection.

Battery translation hypothesis

Informs visual program ideas in Core Blueprint (*yabang*, festival choreography) without importing unrelated drill vocabulary.

Respect and limits

Movement must be reviewed for cultural appropriateness in school contexts.

Field work needed

Kaamulan and MONHS input on acceptable movement references for 2026 show.

Status: Outline

2.5.7 Rhythmic Dialogue**Observed practice**

Alternating short phrases between players or sub-groups—tighter than long-form call-and-response, often at subdivision level.

Musical function

Texture variation, conversational energy, and rhythmic play within stable tempo.

Battery translation hypothesis

Sectional trade figures, answer patterns in cadence writing, and hand-to-hand balance in 8-8-16.

Respect and limits

Dialogue figures should still read as Filipino phrase shape when played in isolation.

Field work needed

Collect examples of traditional “question-answer” grooves instructors already teach by ear.

Status: Outline

2.5.8 Performance Energy

Observed practice

Sustained high commitment—physical presence, attack intensity, and audience orientation—throughout a set or procession.

Musical function

Defines festival and community music as celebratory and participatory, not merely accurate.

Battery translation hypothesis

Informs HBCU-influenced **contrast** (Layer C) only where it amplifies Philippine energy; see [Grid Exercises — HBCU Flash \(Trainers Manual\)](#).

Respect and limits

Energy is not the same as volume; avoid equating Filipino identity with sheer loudness.

Field work needed

Pilot observation: what energy level reads as authentic to local audiences?

Status: Outline

2.6 Research Program

Active research topics with methods, deliverables, and ownership. Update status in [research backlog](#) when complete.

Topic	Central question	Method	Lead	Status	Output
Regional rhythmic studies	How do Bukidnon patterns differ from Visayan festival grooves in accent placement and ensemble role?	Instructor interviews; curated listening in references/	MONHS pilot instructors	Planned	Regional subsections or docs/Research/Regions/ notes

Topic	Central question	Method	Lead	Status	Output
Indigenous performance techniques	Which hand-drum practices are already implicit in local Drum & Lyre teaching?	Rehearsal observation; Project Journal notes	MONHS pilot	Planned	Expanded practice profiles in this document
Dance-percussion relationships	Which movement cues drive accent placement and phrase release?	Kaamulan field observation; video analysis	Project owner + instructors	Planned	Kaamulan Festival; Concept Library updates
Native instruments and musical roles	What musical roles (pulse, answer, drive) do indigenous instruments serve—without copying timbre?	Ethnographic sources; community review	Project owner	Planned	Native Instruments (Trainers Manual) expansion
Comparative respect and attribution	How do we cite sources, credit communities, and avoid misrepresentation?	Governance review; advisor input	Project owner	Planned	Project Governance addendum if needed

2.6.1 Research Ethics

- Obtain permission before recording instructors or students.
- Credit community contributors by name only with consent.
- Do not commit copyrighted ceremonial or commercial recordings to the repository without redistribution rights.
- When uncertain, mark findings **disputed** and seek instructor review before migrating to Concept Library.

2.7 Findings Log

Dated entries summarize confirmed research. Raw notes remain in the **Project Journal**.

2.7.1 2026-07-15 — Research structure established

Expanded bullet outlines into concept profiles, performance-practice profiles, and a formal research program. All entries remain **Outline** status pending MONHS pilot and source review.

2.8 Related Documents

- [Kaamulan Festival](#)
- [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#)
- [Identity Framework — Indigenous Philippine Foundations \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Concept Library](#)
- [Research backlog](#)
- [References](#)
- [Project Journal](#)

3 Kaamulan Festival

Status: Draft **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Cultural research and arranging inspiration **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-16 **Review Frequency:** Annual **Authoritative:** No

3.1 Purpose

The Kaamulan Festival is one of the project’s primary cultural reference points. This document records research topics and findings that inform the [Identity Framework](#).

Kaamulan is treated as **inspiration**, not as material to copy directly.

3.2 Research Topics

Topic profiles below expand the Identity Framework [Kaamulan Festival \(Trainers Manual\)](#) research list. See also [Indigenous Philippine Percussion](#) for cross-tradition concept profiles.

- Rhythmic Layering
- Movement
- Audience Interaction
- Ceremonial Pacing
- Community Participation
- Visual-Musical Integration
- Regional diversity within festival performance — see [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Regional Diversity \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

3.3 Project Application

Insights from Kaamulan research should inform:

- festival energy in performance and arranging
- layered rhythmic writing in battery parts
- movement integrated with musical phrasing

- audience engagement concepts
- the [Philippine Percussion Sound Model](#)

3.4 Findings

Research findings will be recorded here as field work and source analysis progress. See expanded profiles in [Indigenous Philippine Percussion](#).

Pilot instructors—including MONHS (Misamis Oriental National High School) collaborators from Bukidnon—are invited to contribute cultural guidance. See the [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#) and [Instructor Introduction](#).

3.4.1 Rhythmic Layering

Research focus

How multiple rhythmic layers combine in Kaamulan and related Bukidnon festival contexts to create collective groove.

Project links

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Layered Rhythmic Structures \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Interlocking Rhythms \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Philippine Festival Rhythms \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.4.2 Movement

Research focus

Dance-percussion relationships, procession movement, and how gesture co-defines musical phrasing in festival performance.

Project links

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Music Integrated with Movement \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Movement and Dance \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.4.3 Audience Interaction

Research focus

How performers and community audience exchange energy, response, and participation during festival percussion events.

Project links

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Call-and-Response \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Community Performance Traditions \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.4.4 Ceremonial Pacing

Research focus

Ritual order, symbolic pacing, and culturally grounded show arcs—not arbitrary entertainment tempo.

Project links

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Ceremonial Performance \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Philippine Percussion Sound Model — Cadence Architecture \(Reference\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.4.5 Community Participation

Research focus

Active community roles as players, responders, movers, and audience—not detached concert performance.

Project links

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion — Community Participation \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Community Performance Traditions \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.4.6 Visual-Musical Integration

Research focus

When movement, costume, and visual gesture align with musical accent and phrase—not offset showmanship.

Project links

- [Philippine Percussion Sound Model — Visual-Musical Interaction \(Reference\)](#)
- [Core Blueprint — Visual Identity: Philippine Yabang \(Specifications\)](#)

Status: Outline

3.5 Related Documents

- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion](#)
- [Philippine Marching Heritage](#)
- [Identity Framework — Kaamulan Festival \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Concept Library — Philippine Festival Rhythms \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Instructor Introduction](#)
- [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#)
- [Research backlog](#)

4 Philippine Marching Heritage

Status: Draft **Owner:** Philippine Marching Percussion Fusion Project **Applies To:** Historical lineage supporting the Identity Framework **Last Reviewed:** 2026-07-16 **Review Frequency:** Annual **Authoritative:** No

4.1 Purpose

This document records historical and cultural lineage for the **Identity Framework — Historical Foundation (Trainers Manual)**. It supports identity decisions; it does not teach performance technique.

Research here explains how parade, military, school corps, and Drum & Lyre traditions inform the fusion style without becoming substitutes for Philippine festival and indigenous roots.

4.2 Military and Drum and Lyre Heritage

Research question

How did parade, military band, and school Drum & Lyre traditions shape modern Philippine marching percussion—and what should the fusion project preserve vs. adapt?

Topics to document

- Military and civic parade band influence on school corps organization and pulse
- Drum & Lyre Corps (DLC) as the recognizable modern Philippine groove heritage
- Relationship between straight parade pulse and festival-forward syncopation
- What to **preserve**: energetic performance, audience connection, educational accessibility
- What to **adapt**: technique, notation, arranging, rehearsal methods, ensemble balance

Project links

- **Traditional Drum & Lyre Evolution (Trainers Manual)**
- **Philippine Percussion Sound Model** — festival-forward groove vs. straight military pulse
- **Grid Exercises** — DLC/DCI/HBCU hybrid pedagogy context

Field work prompt (MONHS instructors)

Which parade or Drum & Lyre habits already define your corps identity? Which habits should not be replaced by foreign rudimental models?

Status: Outline

4.3 Modern Philippine Marching Performance

Research question

What does contemporary Philippine school and community marching performance look like before fusion writing—and what must remain recognizable after modernization?

Topics to document

- School corps, festival parades, civic celebrations, and regional performance norms
- Typical instrumentation, reading levels, and rehearsal constraints
- Performance energy and audience-facing habits in real Philippine contexts

- Pre-fusion repertoire and rote-teaching culture

Project links

- [Instructor Introduction](#)
- [MONHS 2026 Pilot Brief](#)
- [Core Blueprint](#) — operational roadmap for fusion development

Status: Outline

4.4 Military Drum Corps Influence

Research question

What may be **selectively adapted** from military drum corps tradition without adopting military identity as the sound of the project?

Adapt with caution

- Organizational clarity and sectional responsibility
- Precision that supports—not replaces—festival groove
- Drill-adjacent timing discipline when it serves ensemble communication

Do not adopt as identity

- Straight military pulse as default groove character
- Foreign parade identity substituting for Philippine festival roots
- Visual or sonic templates that obscure community-facing energy

Project links

- [Core Blueprint — Layer B — The Precision \(Specifications\)](#) — where adapted precision belongs
- [Identity Framework — International Influences \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Modernization Without Imitation \(Trainers Manual\)](#)

Status: Outline

4.5 Related Documents

- [Philippine Marching Percussion Identity Framework](#)
- [Indigenous Philippine Percussion](#)
- [Kaamulan Festival](#)
- [Core Blueprint](#)
- [Concept Library — Traditional Drum & Lyre Evolution \(Trainers Manual\)](#)
- [Research backlog](#)
- [Project Journal](#)

4.6 Status

Detailed source analysis and instructor field notes are pending. Findings should migrate to the [Concept Library](#) when field-confirmed.